

» **BEST OF 2025**
TITANS OF THE WORLD

ARMAND DUPLANTIS

ATHLETICS

It has been five years since Armand Duplantis broke Frenchman Renaud Lavillenie's world record (WR) of 6.16m. Since then, the Swedish pole vaulter has continued to raise the bar bit by bit. Not only because he is making gradual improvements but also because every time he betters his own mark at a designated World Athletics meeting, he receives a substantial bonus.

The 2025 season was no different as the 26-year-old set a new WR four times — 6.27m (Clermont-Ferrand), 6.28m (Stockholm Diamond League), 6.29m (Budapest) — and saved the best for last with a clearance of 6.30m at the World Championships in Tokyo. Overall, the double Olympic and three-time world champion has already broken the WR 14 times. For Mondo, the sky is the limit.

The Swede is truly one of the biggest track-and-field stars and hence was recognised by the global body as the Men's World Athlete of the Year. Every time he competes, spectators can safely assume that he is going to win — he has done so in his last 37 competitions, a streak which began at the World Championships 2023 in Budapest. In every event he participates in, the real drama starts once everyone else has been knocked out. Duplantis competing against himself, with the crowd and his competitors cheering for him, is a spectacle at every major championship.

As a side hustle, Duplantis has also released two singles — *Bop* and *4L* — adding another layer to a resume that stretches far beyond the field.

Nihit Sachdeva

